

DRACO

Dotfile & Runtime Archive and Configuration Orchestrator

Quick Guide & Reference Card — v1.0.0

Portable encrypted backup for Linux workstations.
Dotfiles • SSH keys • KDE/GNOME config • Software manifests

Fedora 42+	Debian 12+	Ubuntu 24.04+	Arch Linux
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License: GNU GPL v3 | Encryption: AES-256-CBC + PBKDF2 | Compression: zstd

1. WHAT IS DRACO?

DRACO backs up your **workstation identity**: shell configs, dotfiles, SSH/GPG keys, KDE or GNOME personalizations (including Konsole profiles and Spaceship prompt), and a complete list of installed software with a one-command reinstall script. It does **NOT** back up your personal data (Downloads, Documents, etc.).

All archives are **encrypted with AES-256-CBC** and compressed with **zstd**. Identical backups are deduplicated via SHA-256 (symlink instead of duplicate file). A full history with per-backup logs and diffs is maintained.

2. INSTALLATION

Dependencies (install first)

Fedora	<code>sudo dnf install tar openssl zstd newt</code>
Debian / Ubuntu	<code>sudo apt install tar openssl zstd whiptail</code>
Arch	<code>sudo pacman -S tar openssl zstd libnewt</code>

Install DRACO

```
tar xzf draco-step1.tar.gz
```

```
cd draco
```

```
bash install.sh
```

Note: Installs to `~/local/bin/draco` (user) or `/usr/local/bin/draco` (system).

3. FIRST RUN

```
draco
```

On first run, DRACO prompts for a **backup destination directory** and optionally installs an automatic schedule. All settings are saved to `~/.config/draco/draco.conf`.

■ **NEVER** store your encryption password in `draco.conf`. Use the `DRACO_PASSWORD` environment variable or enter it interactively.

4. COMMAND REFERENCE

Command	Description
<code>draco</code>	Launch TUI (interactive mode)
<code>draco backup</code>	Run backup now
<code>draco restore</code>	Restore (interactive selection)
<code>draco restore <ID></code>	Restore specific backup by ID
<code>draco list</code>	List all backups + sizes + dates
<code>draco log</code>	View log for last backup
<code>draco log <ID></code>	View log for specific backup
<code>draco delete <ID></code>	Delete a backup (with confirmation)
<code>draco schedule install</code>	Install automatic schedule
<code>draco schedule remove</code>	Remove automatic schedule
<code>draco schedule status</code>	Show schedule status + next run
<code>draco config</code>	Configuration wizard
<code>draco status</code>	Show config summary

5. OPTIONS & ENVIRONMENT

Option / Variable	Description
<code>-c FILE / --config FILE</code>	Use alternate config file
<code>-p PWD / --password PWD</code>	Set password on CLI (prefer env var)
<code>-q / --quiet</code>	Suppress non-error output
<code>-v / --verbose</code>	Debug output
<code>--no-color</code>	Disable color output
<code>--version</code>	Print version
<code>-h / --help</code>	Show usage
<code>DRACO_PASSWORD=xxx</code>	Encryption password (env var, no prompt)

DRACO_CONFIG=path	Override config file path
DRACO_BACKUP_DIR=path	Override backup directory
DRACO_LOG_LEVEL=0-3	0=DEBUG 1=INFO 2=WARN 3=ERROR
DRACO_TUI_THEME=...	ghost blood acid matrix void

6. AUTOMATED BACKUPS

Systemd user timer (recommended)

```
draco schedule install # choose systemd, daily, 02:00
```

Store the password for unattended operation:

```
mkdir -p ~/.config/environment.d
```

```
echo 'DRACO_PASSWORD=yourpassword' > ~/.config/environment.d/draco.conf
```

```
chmod 600 ~/.config/environment.d/draco.conf
```

Cron

```
draco schedule install # choose cron
```

```
# Or manually add to crontab:
```

```
DRACO_PASSWORD=yourpassword
```

```
0 2 * * * /home/user/.local/bin/draco backup -q
```

7. RESTORE WORKFLOW

- 1 Install DRACO on new machine (see Section 2)
- 2 Copy backup directory or mount backup storage
- 3 Set DRACO_BACKUP_DIR or run 'draco config'
- 4 Run 'draco restore' and select backup
- 5 Enter encryption password
- 6 Run the reinstall script:

```
bash ~/.local/share/draco/restore-<ID>/reinstall.sh
```
- 7 Restart your session

■ KDE <-> GNOME restore: DE-specific settings are automatically skipped with a warning. All other configs (dotfiles, SSH, etc.) are restored normally.

8. RETENTION POLICIES

all	Keep everything (default). Disk grows indefinitely.
daily	Keep last N daily backups. Set DRACO_RETENTION_KEEP_DAILY.
weekly	Keep last N weekly backups.
monthly	Keep last N monthly backups.
smart	Best for long term: N daily + 1/week N weeks + 1/month N months + 1/year N years.

9. TUI THEMES

ghost	White on near-black (fg=255, bg=232). Native bash 256-color.
blood	Red on near-black (fg=196, bg=232).
acid	Yellow on near-black (fg=226, bg=232).
matrix	Green on near-black (fg=46, bg=232).
void	Cyan on near-black (fg=51, bg=232).

Set via: **draco config** or **DRACO_TUI_THEME=void draco**

10. KEY FILE LOCATIONS

<code>~/.config/draco/draco.conf</code>	Main configuration file
<code>~/.local/share/draco/logs/</code>	Session log files
<code>\$BACKUP_DIR/draco-YYYYMMDD-HHMMSS.*.enc</code>	Encrypted archives
<code>\$BACKUP_DIR/.meta/*.meta</code>	Per-backup metadata
<code>\$BACKUP_DIR/.meta/*.log</code>	Per-backup log / diff
<code>~/.config/systemd/user/draco-backup.*</code>	Systemd units (if installed)
<code>~/.local/share/draco/restore-<ID>/reinstall.sh</code>	Generated reinstall script

11. SECURITY CHECKLIST

- Use a **strong password** (12+ chars, mixed). It protects SSH keys.
- **Never** store password in draco.conf. Use DRACO_PASSWORD env var.
- Set backup directory permissions: **chmod 700 \$DRACO_BACKUP_DIR**
- For systemd: store password in `~/.config/environment.d/draco.conf` (chmod 600)
- Back up your password somewhere safe. Without it, archives are unrecoverable.

12. KNOWN LIMITATIONS

- No user data backup (Downloads, Documents, media). By design.
- Monitor/display config excluded from restore (hardware-specific).
- KDE Activities not backed up.
- Flatpak: only overrides backed up, not per-app data.
- Reinstall script: packages renamed since backup will fail silently.
- npm/pip/snap lists are best-effort only.